



Journal of the American College of Radiology

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Guide for authors

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JACR instructions for Authors

JACR seeks manuscripts pertinent to radiology in five domains:

- health services research and policy
- clinical practice management
- data science
- training and education
- leadership

JACR does not publish clinical review articles, book reviews or case reports.

All submissions to JACR will be screened by the editors for their pertinence to the journal's purview, as well as the significance and quality of the work. The editors may choose to send the manuscript for external peer review or determine its disposition based on their own review.

How to Submit

JACR accepts all new submissions through [Editorial Manager](#). We use a new, simpler submission process promoted by Elsevier called EZ Submit.

EZ Submit

As part of this process, authors may submit their initial article (text, figures, tables, and references) as a single file. This can be a Word or PDF file, in any format or layout, and figures and tables can be placed within the text.

Initial submissions should still have all author and institution information in the main manuscript file masked for the purpose of peer review.

Initial Submission Checklist for All Article Types*

- Title Page with all author information
- Declaration Statement
- Manuscript

*Clicking on each item in the list will take you to the description and item requirements at the end of the document.

If the paper is provisionally accepted or revisions are invited, authors will need to reformat their manuscript to meet JACR requirements and include all the required items for the appropriate manuscript type.

JACR adheres to the [Uniform Requirements for Manuscripts Submitted to Biomedical Journals](#), as well as the American Medical Association Manual of Style.

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Generative AI should only be used to improve language and readability; it cannot be listed as an author or cited as a source. If generative AI is used, you must include the following statement before the references:

Declaration of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies in the writing process

During the preparation of this work the author(s) used [NAME TOOL / SERVICE] in order to [REASON]. After using this tool/service, the author(s) reviewed and edited the content as needed and take(s) full responsibility for the content of the publication.

Article Types

The following information covers the requirements of each type of manuscript. For detailed descriptions of each item to be submitted, please refer to the Submission Items section.

Original Article Original Articles should represent either original, data-driven research or a systematic review of the literature. Submissions should be less than 3,000 words in length, not counting references. There should be no more than 7 tables and figures; there is no official limit on references, but the editors will advise if the listed refs are in excess. The manuscript must contain a formal limitations section if it is original research.

For any article containing original data, please review our [guidelines](#) for avoiding common statistical mistakes prior to submitting.

The following reporting standards for original research manuscripts should be followed:

- for randomized trials: [CONSORT](#)
- for observational studies: [STROBE](#)
- for systematic reviews: [PRISMA](#)
- for quality improvement studies: [SQUIRE](#)
- or applications of artificial intelligence and machine learning: [CLAIM](#)

If provisionally accepted or invited to revise, the authors will need to include the following in their resubmission:

- Title Page
- Declaration Statement
- Main Manuscript File (Unmasked)
- Editable Tables
- Separate Figure Files
- Summary Sentence (< 35 words)
- Take Home Points (3-6)

Brief Reports

Brief Reports are shorter research communications of no greater than 1,400 words, including references. They are by **editor invitation only** and the cover letter must reference this invitation. These brief reports are usually data-driven and akin to research letters. Unsolicited brief reports will be returned to the author. In addition, they must comply with the following formatting requirements:

- Three sections: a brief description of the problem; what the authors did; and outcomes and limitations. No conclusion section is allowed.
- Only the most significant references should be included. References are limited to 8 or fewer.
- The text should be accompanied by no more than 3 tables and/or figures.

If provisionally accepted or invited to revise, the authors will need to include the following in their resubmission:

- Cover Letter
- Title Page
- Declaration Statement
- Main Manuscript File (Unmasked)
- Editable Tables
- Separate Figure Files

Opinion

JACR encourages the submission of commentaries regarding aspects of radiology or healthcare that are within its purview and address topics of contemporary interest. The length of these manuscripts should be no more than 1,400 words including references, which should number no more than 8.

If provisionally accepted or invited to revise, the authors will need to include:

- Title Page
- Declaration Statement
- Main Manuscript File (Unmasked)
- Editable Tables
- Separate Figure Files

Letter to the Editor

The JACR editors welcome letters commenting on previously published articles. Letters must be fewer than 500 words and have no more than 3 references (including the previously published article which is being addressed). Accepted manuscripts in this category will be forwarded to the primary author of the article discussed in the letter. Letters and replies will be published side-by-side in the same issue of the journal. Manuscripts containing inappropriate language or ad hominem attacks will not be considered for publication.

If provisionally accepted or invited to revise, the authors will need to include:

- Title Page
- Declaration Statement
- Main Manuscript File (Unmasked)

Special Issue/Focus Issue

On initial submission, Special or Focus Issue articles should follow the general YPYW guidelines, with one additional item needed: Authors should select the appropriate issue from the category drop-down list when prompted (e.g., "AI in Private Practice" or "Wellness", etc.) to ensure the paper is directed to the appropriate editor.

If provisionally accepted or invited to revise, the authors will need to include:

- Cover Letter
- Title Page
- Declaration Statement

- Main Manuscript File(Unmasked)
- Editable Tables
- Separate Figure Files
- Summary Sentence* (if original research)
- Take Home Points* (if original research)

Submission Items

Please find below the information for each of the submission items listed above and instructions for formatting in accordance with JACR's guidelines

Cover Letter

When applicable, a cover letter should be included to provide additional context for your submission. This can include identifying any companion papers, certifying editor-in-chief approval for the inclusion of additional authors (see Authorship below), or listing the intended focus/special issue.

Title Page

- Title

Authors are encouraged to use succinct titles. Under no circumstances may the title of an article exceed 129 characters, including spaces. JACR does not permit titles in the form of questions. The editor reserves the right to edit the title for clarity and brevity.

- Authors & Affiliations

The Title Page should identify the Corresponding Author and their institutional affiliation, mailing address, email address, telephone number, and-if used-Twitter handle.

The Title Page should also list ALL co-authors and their corresponding affiliations, including city and state, and Twitter handles if available.

Authorship and Contributions

JACR takes seriously its role in safeguarding the meaning of authorship. Inclusion of an author must be based on the guidelines of the International Congress of Medical Journal Editors (ICMJE). These qualifications are explained in detail at <http://www.icmje.org/recommendations/browse/roles-and-responsibilities/defining-the-role-of-authors-and-contributors.html>

The title page must list the contributions of each of the co-authors in each of the ICMJE-listed activities.

Original Article submissions should include no more than 7 authors. Any plan to list more than 7 authors should seek the agreement of the JACR Editor-in-Chief prior to submission.

In addition, Opinion papers should include no more than 5 authors, and Letters should include no more than 3 authors. These limits are without exceptions.

- Leadership Roles

The Title Page should list all leadership roles held by each author. These roles include those held in their respective institution or within the ACR.

- Data Statement

JACR requires all Original Article submissions to include this statement on the Title Page: "The author(s) declare(s) that they had full access to all of the data in this study and the author(s) take(s) complete responsibility for the integrity of the data and the accuracy of the data analysis.

- Funding

The Title Page should also include any sources of support, including grants, funding, or other assistance, whether from public or private sources.

- Declaration Statement

As of June 2023, JACR is collecting conflict of Interest information through the new [Elsevier Declarations](#) tool. The corresponding author should use the tool to generate a statement that captures declarations from all co-authors. Only statements generated using the tool will be accepted as complete COI information. This statement should be uploaded as its own document, and not included on the title page.

Main Manuscript

- Abstract

Abstract should be no longer than 250 words and formatted either as a research abstract (objective, methods, results, discussion) or as appropriate for a review.

- Keywords

Authors should list 3-5 keywords that highlight the main topics of the manuscript.

- References

Avoid citations in the abstract of original articles. Unpublished results and personal communication should not be in the reference list but may be mentioned in the text.

Figures

Any submissions including figures should include a figure legend after the references. Figures should be included in the manuscript document at the time of initial submission. At revision and/or provisional acceptance, all figures should then be uploaded as separate files, in either TIFF, JPEG, or EPS format. To ensure quality on printing, we also ask that all figures be at least 300 dpi. If you have any questions regarding resolution or file types, please contact the editorial office.

Editable Tables

Tables should be included in the manuscript document at the time of initial submission. At revision and/or provisional acceptance, all tables should be editable tables rather than images. They can be embedded in the manuscript or uploaded as separate files

Summary Sentence

For original articles, the summary sentence should best represent the purpose or main conclusion derived from the article, be taken word-for-word from the manuscript, and is limited to 35 words or 250 characters.

Take Home Points

For original articles, the take home points section should list 3-6 principal conclusions of the manuscript in bulleted fashion. This section takes the place of a conclusions section or paragraph at the end of the discussion.

Journal Policy on Prior Publication Including Preprint Servers

For work that has previously been published in other forms including preprint servers, prior publication must be disclosed and access provided to these publications. The submitted work must be substantively different from what has already been published. Authors are also required to include a detailed description of how the present submission differs from any previous publication. Duplicate publications (where the majority of a manuscript is the same as a prior publication) are not permitted.

Problematic manuscripts will be returned to the authors without peer review.

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